

LAB 8 – PART A

HTML / CSS Layout Explanation

Understanding float, clear, and percentage heights

There are two separate issues here.

Issue 1: Why is “Content” appearing in the middle?

In the HTML, the word “Content” is written directly inside the .content div before the floated elements. Because the .entries and .sidebar elements are floated, normal text can flow around them. This can make the word “Content” appear in an unexpected position.

```
<div class="content">Content

  <div class="entries">
    ...
  </div>

  <div class="sidebar">
    Sidebar
  </div>

</div>
```

If “Content” is intended to appear as a heading at the top of the orange section, place it inside its own block-level div before the floated sections.

```
<div class="content">

  <div>Content</div>

  <div class="entries">
    <div class="entry">Entry</div>
    <div class="entry">Entry</div>
    <div class="entry">Entry</div>
  </div>

  <div class="sidebar">
    Sidebar
  </div>

</div>
```

Key idea: float affects how surrounding normal content flows.

Issue 2: Why can't .page use height: 100%?

You can use `height: 100%`, but percentage heights depend on the height of the parent element. In this case, `.page` is inside `<body>`. If the parent does not have an explicitly defined height, the browser does not have a clear height reference for 100%.

```
.page {  
  width: 100%;  
  height: 100%;  
}
```

100% means 100% of the parent's defined height — not automatically 100% of the browser screen.

If you want 100% of the browser viewport

Use `100vh`. The unit `vh` means viewport height. Therefore, `100vh` represents the full height of the visible browser window.

```
.page {  
  width: 100%;  
  height: 100vh;  
}
```

100vh = 100% of the viewport height.

If you specifically want to use height: 100%

Give the parent elements a defined height first. Then `.page` can correctly calculate its 100% height from that parent.

```
html, body {  
  height: 100%;  
}  
  
body {  
  margin: 0;  
}  
  
.page {  
  width: 100%;  
  height: 100%;  
}
```

How the percentage height is calculated

HTML → 100%

BODY → 100%

.page → 100%

For your Lab 8 Part A

If the purpose is to practice percentage heights, use `html, body { height: 100%; }` and then give `.page` a height of 100%. If the purpose is simply to make the page fill the browser screen, `height: 100vh` is the simpler choice.

Also remember: changing `.page` from 300px to 100% does not automatically scale the fixed-height child elements such as 25px, 28px, 190px, and 15px.

Quick CSS Reference

Property	Purpose	Used in this layout
<code>float: left</code>	Moves an element to the left and lets surrounding content flow around it.	<code>.entries</code>
<code>float: right</code>	Moves an element to the right and lets surrounding content flow around it.	<code>.sidebar</code>
<code>clear: both</code>	Stops an element from sitting beside left or right floats.	<code>.footer</code>
<code>height: 100%</code>	Uses 100% of the parent's defined height.	<code>.page</code>
<code>height: 100vh</code>	Uses 100% of the viewport height.	<code>.page</code>

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